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HRRP BULLETIN

16 April 2018



Namadi Bazaar, Ramechhap: the home owner has built a one room, one storey "earthquake-safe" house next to their old, damaged house which they are still living in, in order to access the GoN housing reconstruction grant. Photo Credit: BBC Media Action.



Poku, Ramechhap: the home owner has built a one room, one storey 'earthquake-safe' building next to their old, damaged house in order to access the GoN housing reconstruction grant. They continue to live in the old house because the new one is too small for the family. Photo Credit: BBC Media Action.



Khijichandeshwari, Okhaldhunga: the home owner has built a new house which only has a kitchen and one bedroom (on right-hand side of photo). They continue to use the damaged house (on the left-hand side of the photo) to store their grains and belongings because the new home is not big enough. Photo Credit: BBC Media Action.



Khijiphalate Bazaar, Okhaldhunga: home owners in this area first built large houses right after the earthquake and later built smaller ones in order to receive the GoN housing reconstruction grant. Photo Credit: BBC Media Action.

Highlights

- The NRA has [extended the deadline to receive the second tranche](#) of the GoN housing reconstruction grant to 16 July 2018. The previous deadline was 13 April (last Friday).
 - [Organisational restructure of NRA approved](#) during 12th Steering Committee meeting on 3 April; Central and District Level Project Implementation Units now under NRA
 - [Session on 'Introduction of a Professional Title for Engineers in Nepal & Staff Development Opportunities through Internship and Graduate Programmes', Tuesday 17 April, 3-5pm, HRRP Office, Jwagal](#)
 - [Invitation, HRRP Event to Mark the Third Anniversary of the 2015 Earthquake](#) – please do join us for this event, on 23 April, which includes a district exhibition and general meeting
 - HRRP IM team have cleaned and converted CBS Earthquake micro data on “Household registration for household reconstruction” to the new federal structure. Please contact Uttam Paudel, HRRP IM Manager, im.manager@hrrpnepal.org, if there are any specific maps that you would like prepared using this data.
 - [NRA Report, 'Two Years of Reconstruction' \(Nepali\)](#)
 - HRRP Notice Regarding Support to Vulnerable Households and 'Leave No One Behind'
 - Reconstruction updates from Chitwan, Nawalpur, Parasi, Solukhumbhu, and Khotang
 - [Housing Reconstruction Progress Maps](#): based on MoUD CLPIU inspection data as of 5 April.
 - [Technical Assistance Coverage Maps](#): based on HRRP 4W data as of 25 March 2018.
 - **Reminder:** for the month of April the HRRP will be distributing the bulletin every two weeks instead of weekly. This is a trial and we are keen to get feedback and suggestions to info@hrrpnepal.org. If a significant portion of the mailing list would prefer that the bulletin continues to be issued weekly, we will revert to this from May.
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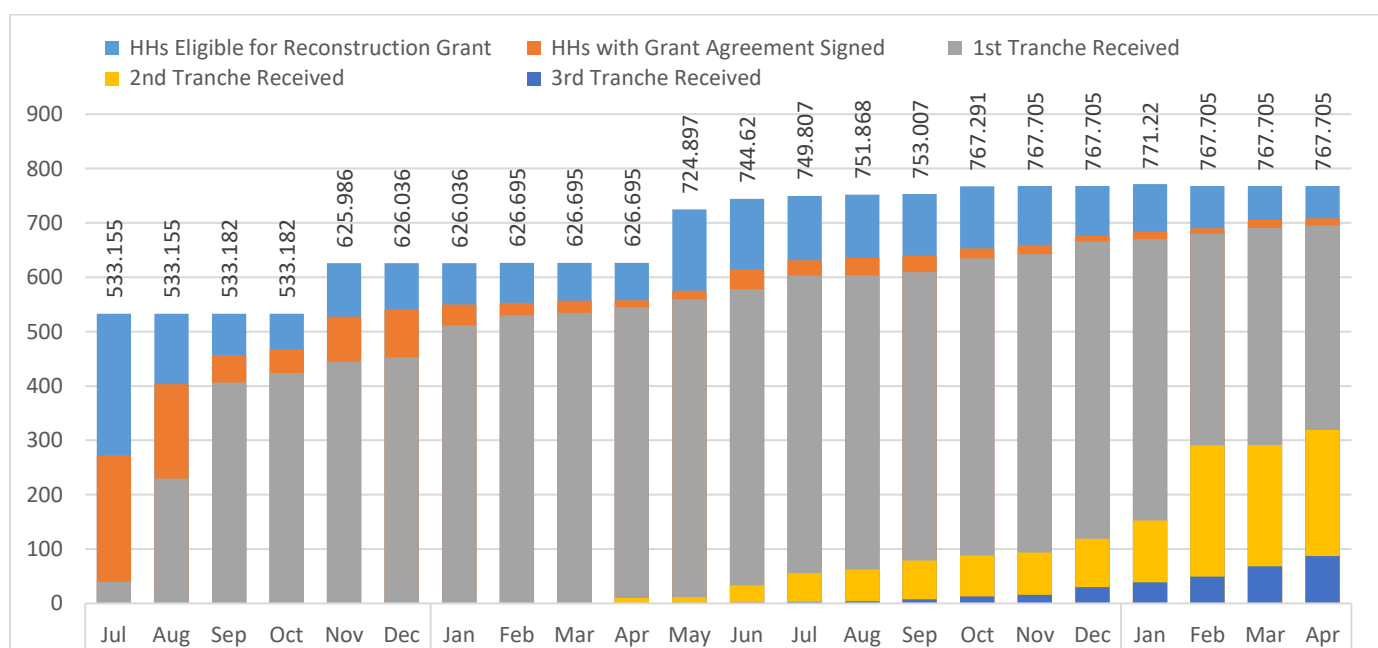
UPDATES & REQUESTS

National

Second Tranche Deadline Extended to 16 July 2018: during the 12th Steering Committee meeting on 3 April, the NRA agreed the extension of the deadline to receive the second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant to 16 July 2018. The previous deadline was 13 April (last Friday). The 16 July falls during the monsoon season when there will be a reduced level of construction taking place. The photos at the beginning of the bulletin illustrate a trend seen across all earthquake affected areas where the pressure of the deadline has led to people constructing very small houses simply to receive the GoN housing grant, and then continuing to live in their old house, or planning to build another house at a later date.

MoFALD CLPIU Enrolment Data, as of 15 April (Nepali and Unofficial English Translation):

	23 March	1 April	15 April
Total No. Eligible HHs	767,685	767,705	767,705
HHs Enrolled	704,388	705,616	708,610
HHs Received 1st Tranche	679,442	691,107	695,384
HHs Applied for 2nd Tranche	265,784	274,781	296,950
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	255,082	292,595	319,012
HHs Applied for 3rd Tranche	66,091	70,643	82,418
HHs Received 3rd Tranche	54,373	68,167	87,253



Housing reconstruction progress based on MoFALD CLPIU enrolment data from July 2016 to April 2018.

HRRP Notice Regarding Support to Vulnerable Households and 'Leave No One Behind': there is an increasing amount of planning taking place for programming of funding to provide additional support to vulnerable households. Regarding this HRRP would like to raise the following points:

- We are trying to map planned coverage of vulnerable support to try to provide early indications of any possible gaps / duplications. To do this we need your help! POs that are planning additional support to vulnerable households are requested to share as much information as possible (recognising that this may

change during the planning process) with Uttam Paudel, HRRP IM Manager, im.manager@hrrpnepal.org. This will be an iterative process as planning changes or is finalised.

- We would like to request Partner Organisations that have conducted their own survey for the identification of vulnerable households to share the findings and dataset with Uttam Paudel, HRRP IM Manager, im.manager@hrrpnepal.org.
- HRRP would strongly recommend partners consider areas which have not received any PO support to date for additional vulnerable support. Details of PO presence are available through the [4W dataset](#) but please feel free to contact Minar Thapa Magar, HRRP National Coordination Officer, minar@hrrpnepal.org, for specific details related to your possible working areas.
- Support for vulnerable households should include Socio-Technical Assistance (STA) ([description of core package](#)) and HRRP recommend that this should not exclude households that are less vulnerable. From a practical perspective it is anyway unlikely that STA teams could provide information to only certain households in their working area, but it is also key that efforts to make sure no one is left behind, don't in themselves leave households behind.
- Serious consideration needs to be given to adequate and appropriate training and mentoring for STA teams before they are mobilised, and on a regular basis while they are in the field. Vulnerability is a complex thing, and teams should be prepared for a range of aspects such as caste, language, poverty, education level, gender, etc.
- HRRP would appreciate it if Partner Organisations (POs) could share examples of ways in which they are already providing / have provided additional support for vulnerable households. Examples can be sent to Anu Prasai Lama, HRRP National Coordination Officer, nco1@hrrpnepal.org. We can then compile these and share as a potential tool for other POs planning such support.
- HRRP is planning to hold some working sessions on support for vulnerable households in the coming weeks. Please share any suggestions for topics, presenters, etc. with Anu Prasai Lama, HRRP National Coordination Officer, nco1@hrrpnepal.org.

Promoting Safer Building Programme, 13 April Workshop: the Promoting Safer Building Programme is an interdisciplinary research study being carried out by an alliance between CARE International UK (CARE UK), Overseas Development Institute (ODI), University College London-EPICentre (EPICentre), the British Geological Survey (BGS), and Loughborough University. During the workshop, the Promoting Safer Building team presented findings from a two-week interdisciplinary research study on the recovery of urban communities living in Bhaktapur and Chautara, Sindhupalchowk. Following the presentation, the participants shared experiences, issues, and challenges related to urban recovery and reconstruction and worked together to map out barriers with possible solutions and opportunities for action oriented research. The barriers and opportunities were discussed at community and policy level based on experiences from partners and donors working in an urban context. Ongoing and completed research related to recovery and reconstruction were mapped along with co-relation and connections between government academic institutions, partners and donors, to avoid duplication and with objective to share updated research and resources within the larger interested working groups and circle.

Districts & Municipalities

HRRP District Exhibitions & Technical Workshops, Marking the 3rd Anniversary of the Gorkha Earthquake:

exhibitions have already taken place in Kavrepalanchowk on 10 April, Okhaldhunga on 11 April, Sindhupalchowk on 12 April, Kathmandu Valley on 13 April, and in Sindhuli and Dolakha on 16 April. The exhibition in Gorkha, Makwanpur, and Nuwakot will take place on 17 April, and in Ramechhap, Dhading, and Rasuwa on 18 April.



Dolakha District Exhibition, 16 April (L) and Gayatri Khawas shares about her experience working as a mason after completing an OJT course during the Dolakha technical workshop, 16 April (R). Gayatri shared that she and five other women have formed a team and have been working together since they completed the OJT training 2 months back. They have built four houses so far. They feel this shows that women can work in construction and be masons. They will continue to work as masons for as long as there is work available.



Kathmandu Valley District Exhibition (L) and Kavrepalanchok District Exhibition (R).

Reconstruction Updates from Chitwan, Nawalpur, Parasi, Solukhumbhu, and Khotang: across all of the districts misinformation and confusion are present at all levels – field, local, and district. There is no clear and uniform understanding on reconstruction policies, guidelines and processes. This is compounded by a lack of coordination and communication between reconstruction related authorities specially between district line agencies and new local bodies. There are no Partner Organisations (POs) providing support for housing reconstruction in these districts. The GoN technical staff and engineers present in these districts have not been trained or oriented on the reconstruction process, systems, and technical guidelines and manuals and are therefore not able to apply these in their work or share relevant information with households and masons.

- In **Khotang** 8,443 HHs are eligible to receive the GoN housing reconstruction grant and 253 are eligible to receive the GoN retrofit grant. The PA has been signed with 8,151 HHs, all of whom have received the first tranche. There have been no inspections for second tranche disbursement in the district. The MoUD DLPIU office has just been established and they do not have a computer so they cannot update information on the MIS, they do not have any inspection files, and they are not clear on the inspection process. Most houses which have already been built are two-storey, stone and mud mortar masonry and are non-compliant. Households are not able to apply correction measures as the engineers cannot support with this and in some cases they cannot afford to make corrections. In town areas, households are waiting for new RCC designs which include a shutter at ground floor level so that they can use their house for commercial purposes.

- In **Solukhumbu** 11,979 HHs are eligible to receive the GoN housing reconstruction grant. The PA has been signed with 10,385 HHs and 10,113 HHs have received the first tranche. 316 HHs have started their construction. 251 HHs have been approved for the release of the second tranche and 2 HHs have been approved for the third tranche. The MoUD DLPIU office has not been established yet and inspection files are verified by DLPIU Engineers from Okhaldhunga so the inspection files need to wait each month for the DLPIU engineers to come and verify the files. Most of the houses which were built already are two-storey, stone and mud mortar masonry and non-compliant. Technical Manpower is very low in the district, and some Rural Municipalities do not even have one engineer. There has also been a lot of turnover in the engineers that are present due to the challenges of working in this district.
- In **Parasi**, 20 HHs are eligible to receive the GoN housing reconstruction grant. 17 HHs have received the first tranche. 3 HHs have been approved for the release of the second tranche. All inspection forms need to be brought to Chitwan. There is a lack of trained masons in the district. Maintaining a proper MIS for the inspection data is challenging and there are many non-compliances as people had rebuilt before the reconstruction standards were introduced.
- In **Nawalpur**, 852 HHs are eligible to receive the GoN housing reconstruction grant and 8 are eligible to receive the GoN retrofit grant. 846 HHs have received the first tranche. 82 HHs have been approved for the release of the second tranche and 7 HHs have been approved for the third tranche. All inspection forms need to be brought to Chitwan and there are no GoN offices in this district yet as it has just been established. There is a lack of trained masons in the district. Maintaining a proper MIS for the inspection data is challenging and there are many non-compliances as people had rebuilt before the reconstruction standards were introduced.
- In **Chitwan**, 7,335 HHs are eligible to receive the GoN housing reconstruction grant and 593 are eligible to receive the GoN retrofit grant. 5,423 HHs have received the first tranche. 478 HHs have been approved for the release of the second tranche and 13 HHs have been approved for the third tranche. The NRA and MoUD DLPIU offices in Chitwan also cover Parasi and Nawalpur. There is a lack of trained masons in the district. There are many non-compliances as people had rebuilt before the reconstruction standards were introduced.



Solu Dudhkunda Municipality, Ward No. 11, Tignasa, Solukhumbu: the homeowner built this house one year after the earthquake after spending a year living in a tent following the complete collapse of their home during the 2015 earthquake. The house has been built with stone and mud mortar masonry and is non-compliant since the attic height and the opening in the first floor are not appropriate. The homeowner has already received the first tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant and is hoping that houses which were completed before the tranche process was launched will receive the second and third tranches without having to make any corrections. The cost of constructing this house was 500,000 NPRs.



Diktel Rupakot Majhuwagadhi Municipality, Ward No. 1, Gairi Tole, Khotang: this hybrid structure, which is non-compliant, has been constructed using stone and mud mortar masonry for the ground floor and CGI sheets and vertical posts for the first floor. No banding has been included and the home owner needs to make corrections in order to receive the second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant. They are very poor though and cannot afford to make the required corrections. The house was built without any technical support immediately after the earthquake.

Sarita Waiba, a leading role in rebuilding of houses in Rasuwa: it is a common stereotype in Nepal that women cannot do construction work, such as masonry and carpentry, well. Sarita Waiba, from Shramthali Village Development Committee (VDC), Rasuwa is proving that women are capable of working in construction. Sarita has been living with her husband and four children in a temporary shelter since their house collapsed during the 25 April 2015 earthquake. When Sarita heard about the 50 day on the job mason training programme being provided by the Helvetas Reconstruction Skills project she discussed it with her husband and then applied to take part. During the training Sarita was part of a group of 10 trainees, under the direct supervision of one lead and one assistant instructor. There were two other women in Sarita's training group. During the training, Sarita and the group completed construction of two houses. Other villagers are now requesting Sarita to work on their houses, especially since the trainees have been recommended by the GoN engineers working in that area. Sarita is now working on her first house since completing the training and is earning 800 NPRs per day. The team that she trained with have prioritised completing construction of their own homes before they work on other's houses. Sarita has also been providing advice to other masons in the area, including her husband who has worked in construction for seven years. She enjoys being able to teach others about how to construct earthquake resilient houses.



HRRP District and Municipal Coordination Meetings, 1 – 15 April: during this period district coordination meetings took place in Ramechhap (5 April) and Kathmandu (9 April). Municipal level meetings took place in Raksirang Rural Municipality, Makwanpur (5 April), Jugal Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok (6 April) and Gandaki Rural Municipality, Gorkha (13 April). Some of the highlights from these meetings include:

- In Ramechhap, the meeting was focused on findings from Dorumba Rural Municipality (RM) where most households have already constructed the foundation of their house. Despite this, most people in the RM are still confused about the process to access the three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant, and the grievance process. In Ward 7 of the RM there are 12 households in a hazardous location that need to be relocated but there are not clear on how to proceed with this. Overall in the district there are 4,000-5,000 people that have been trained as masons, but most of the skilled masons working in the district have come from other districts. Of the women that have been trained as masons only a very small number are now working on reconstruction. It was recommended that the District Coordination Committee should provide notice in the RMs regarding tranche payment so that households do not have to regularly travel to their bank.
- In Raksirang RM, Makwanpur there was discussion around challenges with mobilisation of technicians and the lack of regular coordination between households and engineers. There was also discussion around the process for engineers to inspect houses which have already been completed for the second and third tranche, and what standards the toilet must meet in order for that component of the third tranche to be released. It was agreed that a reconstruction coordination meeting will be held in the RM at the end of each month.
- In Jugal RM, Sindhupalchok the new GoN engineers have been posted without training or equipment (tablets, printers). Some engineers have received verbal threats from people in their working areas. The banks in the area are not able to serve enough people (they serve 20-25 people per day, but 300 people want to access banking services each day), and they generally do not have enough cash on the premises to manage disbursement of tranches to everyone who travels to get their tranches. In Hagam-6, 81 households were left out during the initial damage survey. There have been calls for re-conducting the survey but this has not happened yet. The ward chairman of Hagam-6 had shared that some of the beneficiaries have received the tranche by approving the files from engineers allocated in different Municipalities. The cost of raw materials for building is soaring. The price has increased more as the deadline for receiving the second tranche approached. There is a shortage of skilled masons. There has been quite a lot of mason trainings but they have not been effective. According to the ward chief of Jugal-4, people are not trusting the newly trained masons. There is the lack of clarity in the guidelines for the resettlement of the displaced households. The construction of one room houses is on the rise. Some of beneficiary has repaired their existing house which they live in and they constructed one room house in another place to receive the GoN housing reconstruction grant. There have been instances of inspection files being lost.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dhading, Weekly District Report, 30 Mar – 12 April 2018



Ward No. 2, Netrawati Rural Municipality, Dhading: a single storey, two roomed, stone and mud mortar masonry house with timber bands. The owner has received the first tranche and has been approved for the second and third tranches. The total estimated cost of constructing the house is 500,000 NPRs.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu, Weekly District Report, 30 Mar – 12 April 2018



Ward No. 4, Konjosyom Rural Municipality, Lalitpur: a single storey, brick and cement mortar masonry house with CGI roof. The home owner has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Makwanpur, Weekly District Report, 30 Mar – 12 April 2018



Ward No. 3, Raksirang Rural Municipality, Makwanpur: a single storey, two roomed, brick and cement mortar masonry house with flexible roof. All horizontal and vertical elements have been provided. The home owner has received the second tranche and has been approved for the third tranche. The total estimated cost of constructing the house is 500,000 NPRs.

HRRP District Coordination Team Ramechhap, Weekly District Report, 30 Mar – 12 April 2018



Ward No. 7, Ramechhap Municipality, Ramechhap: a single storey, two roomed stone in cement mortar masonry house. The home owner has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant. The total cost of constructing the house was 550,000 NPRs. The house was constructed with technical assistance from NRCS.

HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhuli, Weekly District Report, 30 Mar – 12 April 2018



Ward No. 6, Phikkal Rural Municipality, Sindhuli: single storey, stone and mud mortar masonry house. The home owner has completed the construction and is waiting for third tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

Requests for Partner Support

Reminder, Session on 'Introduction of a Professional Title for Engineers in Nepal & Staff Development Opportunities through Internship and Graduate Programmes', Tuesday 17 April, 3-5pm, HRRP Office, Jwagal

Intrepid Solutions Lecture Series, Nepal Engineers' Association, Tuesdays, 5pm: supported by UNOPS and Build Change, this lecture series provides an opportunity to connect with national and international experts to explore innovative solutions for improving construction practices. The next lecture will take place on Tuesday, 17 April and will be delivered by Carlos Andres Arce (Lead Structural Engineer, UNESCO Kathmandu) on 'Application of Non-Linear Capacity Analysis to Determine the Safety Level of Heritage Buildings in Nepal: The Case Study of the Gopinath Temple in Kathmandu Durbar Square'.

Invitation, HRRP Event to Mark the Third Anniversary of the 2015 Earthquake: a district exhibition and general meeting (similar to the event on 13 December) will take place on 23 April at the Bougainville Banquet. We look forward to seeing you all there. Please feel free to contact Sufi Mohamed Faiz, HRRP District Management Team-Coordinator, dmt.coord@hrrpnepal.org, if you have any questions regarding the event.

Request to Partners to Share Research Datasets and Reports: there is an enormous amount of research work related to the housing reconstruction that has been completed by partners, or is being carried out on a regular basis. HRRP would like to request partners to make all relevant datasets and reports available to the greatest extent possible. HRRP can support with pulling together data in ways that manages any confidentiality restraints that partners have. Building a strong knowledge base will improve all reconstruction actors understanding of the reconstruction context and what can be improved. Partners interested to share data / reports may contact Siobhan Kennedy, HRRP Recovery Advisor, siobhan@hrrpnepal.org, with any questions, or may directly upload materials to the HRRP Google Drive [here](#).

USAID Nepal Request for Proposals, Sajhedari - Support to Federalism Activity: the deadline for submission of concept papers is 18 May, 13:00 PM NPT. A pre-proposal conference will take place at the US Embassy on 19 April

19 at 13:00 PM NPT. Those interested to attend need to send their full name, title, and contact number to kathmanduoaexchange@usaid.gov no later than 17 April. Questions may be submitted in writing prior to the conference via email to kathmanduoaexchange@usaid.gov.

DOCUMENTS & PRODUCTS

Government of Nepal

[NRA Report, 'Two Years of Reconstruction' \(Nepali\)](#)

[NRA Newsletter, March 2018](#): includes an infographic providing updates on reconstruction progress across multiple sectors, reconstruction stories from several districts including Sindhupalchowk, Sindhuli, and Makwanpur, a detailed financial report on how much NRA has received from development partners and the expenditure incurred till the end of March 2018, opinion pieces from Bigyan Pradhan, Acting Country Director, The World Bank and Renaud Meyer, Country Director, UNDP, and an interview on inclusive reconstruction with Netra Subedi, Head of the NRA's Policy, Monitoring, Coordination, and Social Development Division.

HRRP

[Housing Reconstruction Progress Maps](#): based on MoUD CLPIU inspection data as of 5 April.

[Partnership Agreement Signed between HH and GoN](#)

[1st Tranche Received](#)

[Construction Started](#)

[Compliance Rate – 2nd Tranche](#)

[Compliance Rate – 3rd Tranche](#)

[Construction Completed](#)

[Technical Assistance Coverage Maps](#): based on HRRP 4W data as of 25 March 2018.

[Coverage of 7 Technical Assistance Activities – 14 Districts](#)

[Coverage of 7 Technical Assistance Activities – 32 Districts](#)

[Door to Door Technical Assistance](#)

[Community & Household Orientations](#)

[Demonstration House Construction](#)

[Helpdesk / Technical Resources Centre](#)

[Masons Short Training Coverage](#)

[Masons Vocational Training Coverage](#)

[Map of Vulnerable Households Identified by NRA \(18,505 HHs\): by density and numbers by administrative unit](#)

[Mapping of CBS Earthquake Micro Data from "Household registration for household reconstruction"](#): the HRRP IM team have cleaned this data and converted it to the new federal structure. Please contact Uttam Paudel, HRRP IM Manager, im.manager@hrrpnepal.org, if there are any specific maps that you would like prepared using this data.

Partners

[‘Mero Neelakantha Mero Mobile’ App, Kathmandu Living Labs:](#) Neelakantha Municipality, Dhading inaugurated the mobile application on 15 April. The app is designed to promote open local governance through increased transparency, mutual accountability, and citizen participation in the municipality. Using the ‘Talk to the Mayor’ feature, citizens of Neelakantha can directly contact the mayor's office using their social media account. Information related to municipal services such as the procedures, required documents, estimated time of completion, and tariffs are also available and can be accessed offline through the app. Other features of the app include the municipality budget, an interactive map of government offices, schools, hospitals, etc., and tracking of projects in the municipality from project proposal through procurement to construction and completion (also available on an interactive map). Speaking at the inauguration, Dinesh Thapaliya, Secretary at the Ministry of Federal Affairs and General Administration, said that the app will be developed further in collaboration with MoFAGA in a bid to make it useful and uniform for all municipalities in Nepal.

[Milijuli Nepali, BBC Media Action, Episode 923:](#) this episode is a discussion amongst the presenter, a singer, a comedian, and an engineer who have all been affected by the 2015 earthquake. They discuss their problems with the engineer and ask questions related to building a safe, mud-mortar house in the villages, in a cost-effective way.

[Baliyo Ghar TV Programme, Episode No. 99:](#) this week, the focus is on ‘Reconstruction Efforts and Progress after Gorkha Earthquake’ and the programme includes interviews with Mr. Hit Bahadur Tamang, Member of Parliament, Nuwakot – 2, and, Mr. Surya Narayan Shrestha, Executive Director, NSET.



[‘Asian Development Outlook \(ADO\) 2018: How Technology Affects Jobs’, Asian Development Bank:](#) the report includes interesting findings about the increase in private debt accumulation in developing countries in Asia. It is highlighted that “private debt accumulation spurs growth only in the short run. Evidence shows that the positive effect of household debt growth in emerging economies typically dissipates after 2 years, turning negative in the medium term”. It is recommended that based on this there needs to be close monitoring of the buildup of private debt. In the context of the housing reconstruction in Nepal this is highly relevant. The [HRRP Cost of Construction report from October 2017](#) indicated that we may be facing a potential debt crisis.

 56% of respondents have taken, or are planning to take, a loan to finance the reconstruction of their home.

 Average interest rate is 23%, ranging from 0% to 43%.

 On average, loan amount represents 50% of total construction costs.

Are we looking at a potential debt crisis?

- 767,705 households are eligible for the 300,000 NPRs reconstruction grant from the GoN (as of 23 November)
- If 400,000 of these households take a loan of 3,250 USD, that is **1.3 billion USD in debt**
- The high interest rates many households are paying may mean that their long term recovery will be heavily affected by indebtedness

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